Knowledge organiser for causes of war

Tuesday 5 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 1 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W01

White paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

Learning outcome: Explain the causes of a 20th-century conflict.

Scope: the Second World War in Europe. Fighting in Asia had begun earlier.

Date	Evidence and significance
1919	S1 Treaty terms created resentment later exploited by Nazis. Context, not an automatic cause.
1933 onward	S2 Hitler became chancellor. Nazi dictatorship pursued armed expansion.
1938 to March 1939	S3 Munich concessions failed to stop further expansion into Czech lands.
1 September 1939	S4 Nazi Germany invaded Poland. The immediate trigger.
3 September 1939	S4 Britain and France declared war on Germany.

An explanation needs a link

Cause + dated evidence + how it raised the risk. Use at least two causes. Keep the immediate trigger clear. War was not inevitable and aggression is not justified by earlier resentment.

Careful language

Nazi leaders and participants made decisions. Do not blame every German person. Nazi persecution of Jewish people began before war. The Holocaust and the wider war are connected but distinct.

Where this leads: historians and museum educators check evidence and explain how events connect.

You may pass, ask for a private pause, or use a chosen response mode. These are teacher-written summaries, not historical quotations.